

Basic Units: Noun Phrases

- **Noun phrase:** an argument of a clause is generally a noun phrase. Two major classes:
 - Proper nouns or names (of people, places, organizations etc.)
 - Common nouns, possibly along with some modifiers
 - Possible modifiers: adjectives (e.g., fast, thin), relative clauses, cardinals or ordinals (e.g., one, first), modifying nouns (e.g., shipping company)
 - Noun phrases generally have a *head*, a word that determines the semantic type of the whole phrase, and is an essential component of its meaning
 - Shipping **company**
 - Fast **runner**
 - The **man** who wasn't there